Fourth NAM Summit, Algiers (Algeria), 5–9 September 1973

The Algiers Conference was a historic moment for NAM for it was the largest international gathering at that time outside the United Nations. Seventy-five non-aligned countries attended, which was an increase of 22 over the previous Summit, which equalled to nearly two-thirds of the UN membership and over 90 per cent of the newly independent countries post-Second World War. There were eight observer states, all from Latin America and the Caribbean, and three guest states, all from Europe. In addition, 15 national liberation movements and political parties attended the Summit as observers and made presentations. But the remarkable event was the address by the Secretary-General of the UN, Kurt Waldheim, which indicated the growing importance of the Movement.

Current international situation influenced the proceedings of the Summit. The shift from confrontation to détente between the major powers was welcomed by the NAM countries, but concerns were expressed at the tensed situations in the Middle-East, continued apartheid in South Africa, Sino–Soviet split and Chinese accusations of Soviet 'imperialism', the situation in Indo-China, Liberation struggles of Latin America being crushed by the United States, its opposition to the Allende government in Chile, and continued surveillance by USA to ensure Cuba's political and economic isolation in Latin America.

The Political Declaration reflected the outlook of the non-aligned leaders to link the political and economic dimensions of global security. Genuine independence was defined broadly and made exhaustive by including cultural and social aspects as well as economic and political concerns. Alongside, anti-imperialist and anti-colonialist tenor of the Movement continued. Concerns were expressed over the massive assault on the national liberation struggles and the Movement reaffirmed its historic support for these struggles and adopted a separate Declaration on the Struggle for National Liberation. The Algiers Summit was noteworthy in the sense that the NAM members adopted an Economic Declaration and Action Programme, a radical statement demanding the establishment of a New International Economic Order (NIEO).